NYU | LIBRARIES

DATA SERVICES

Bits and Bytes

October 2026

Hello Data Enthusiast,

We hope you've settled into the fall semester by now and are looking forward to a cozier atmosphere here at NYU! With midterms and project deadlines approaching so quickly, just remember Data Services is here to help. Explore the many ways we support researchers at NYU by visiting our website.

Events

Local Contexts Hub Access for Indigenous Data Research & Film Screening November 16



We are excited to announce our partnership with Local Contexts, a nonprofit organization and "global initiative that supports Indigenous communities with tools that can reassert cultural authority in heritage collections and data" including Local Contexts Labels and/or Notices. We administer accounts for the Local Contexts Hub and work with our partners at Local Contexts and NYU's Center for Collaborative Indigenous Research with Communities and Lands (Center CIRCL) to provide training. Learn more about the Local Contexts Hub and Indigenous data sovereignty on our new Local Contexts LibGuide.

We are hoping to learn more about what our community would like to know about Local Contexts and Indigenous Data Sovereignty. Please fill

out our brief **survey**.

We also encourage you to join us for a screening of the short documentary "Awasəwehlɑwə́lətinɑ wikəwɑmok | They Returned Home," followed by a discussion with Dr. Jordan Kinder at 20 Cooper Square, 3rd Floor on November 16 at 4pm; more information and RSVP here.

Data Carpentry Workshop



Image Credit: datacarpentry.org

Ready to level up your data skills? Join us for a two-day Data Carpentry workshop on November 9 and 10. Using a social science-themed dataset, we'll explore data preparation techniques and learn useful programming languages and platforms for data manipulation and analysis like R and OpenRefine.There are no prerequisites, and the materials assume no prior knowledge.

This workshop is a valuable training opportunity for anyone at NYU whose work or research increasingly includes data management and analysis activities. The Carpentries curriculum is an established and proven instructional program that accommodates a wide range of learners and aims to impart real-world usable skills to participants.

Date: November 9-10, 2026
Time: 10 am - 4 pm
Location: Bobst Library, Room 743

Register for the workshop's limited seats.The full course schedule and setup instructions can be found here.

Faculty Research Carnival

The second annual NYU Faculty Research Carnival is taking place on October 28, 2026. Come learn about the many services offered in support of faculty research from across the university. Over a dozen teams will be

there to answer your questions, introduce you to new and existing tools and resources, and help troubleshoot issues.

Date: October 28th, 2026
Time: 3 pm - 5 pm
Location: Silver Center 1st floor, Hemmerdinger Hall

Register here by October 26th!

GIS Day 2026: Powering Purpose and Innovation



Image Credit: https://www.gisday.com

Our program for GIS Day 2026 is now live! This year will look a little different. To start with, we're partnering with GISMO NYC, Columbia University, and Pratt Institute to host a one-day GeoAI hack-a-thon on Saturday, November 14, 2026 at Pratt Manhattan. Then join us on November 18, 2026 from 12-4pm at NYU's Brooklyn campus (370 Jay Street) for a keynote from Scott Reinhard, former New York Times Graphics Editor, lightning talks from researchers across NYU, the award ceremony for the hack-a-thon, and more! Full details and registration links for the hack-a-thon and GIS Day can be found here. We'll see you there!

Upcoming Events around NYU

- World Digital Preservation Day (ask experts all your digital preservation questions!) | November 5, 2026
- NFL Big Data Bowl - NYU Edition | November 10, 20

Faculty Partner Spotlight: Debanjan Roychoudhury



Photo Credit: Debanjan Roychoudhury

Q. What is your name, school/department/lab?
Debanjan Roychoudhury, Ph. D.
NYU Tandon School of Engineering, Center for Urban Science + Progress

Q. How have you/do you continue to work with Data Services?
My earliest experiences with Data Services were showing up to Bobst 5th floor, often unannounced or without any prior appointment, and asking questions to the GIS specialist on staff that day. I've had the immense pleasure of working with specialists, past and present, including Godfried, Snigdha, and Sohei. I can't thank them enough for all their support, not only on the technical aspects of working in ArcGIS, but also project development, data management, workflows, and cartographic design. Their unique expertise is so invaluable, and it really means the world to have them work so closely, intentionally, and be so gracious with their time. They have become professional contacts and colleagues and folks I can connect with and depend on to this day.

I'm a proud alumnus of the FORC program, where I learned how to build RAG pipelines for research back in 2025, something that I've carried with me and implemented into my work since. I've been able to tap the expertise of Him Mistry, Michelle Thompson Gumbs, and Fabiha Khalid, when I organized the 2026 PITUN Tech for Change Hackathon, focused on urban informatics for decarceration, in spring 2026. It was such a fun and dynamic 3-day event, involving city agencies, non profits, and industry professionals, interacting with faculty and students alike, and it would not have been possible without my good friends and support network at Data Services!

Q. What do you value most about Data Services?
What I most value about Data Services is how approachable everyone is. It has never been difficult to connect with a Data Services specialist and

I've brought numerous students, working on ongoing projects, to the 5th floor of Bobst and seen instantly how they're able to get support and feedback on projects in development. This sort of resource is the heart of being able to conduct high-quality research in real time, and cannot be overstated. I can't recommend Data Services events, support, consultations, and in-class workshops enough! They make the job of being a faculty member and researcher that much more meaningful, because of the community of support, and the quality of engagement they commit to, day in and day out.

Q. How has Data Services impacted your research and/or teaching?
I've been fortunate enough to benefit from engagement with various of the Data Services curricular offerings over the years, having taken classes in Machine Learning and Open Data, which made often difficult or complex topics feel approachable in a hands-on and generative setting. I had Data Services specialist Anik speak with my doctoral students in Applied Statistics, Social Science, and Humanities at Steinhardt, when I taught Fieldwork: Data Collection & Data Analysis from 2024-25. I was also fortunate enough to participate in GIS Day for 2 straight years now, first as part of the mapping competition in 2024, and then as a lightning talk presenter in 2025. This is where I've found my GIS community and how I initially connected with CUSP, where I am now a faculty member, passing on the gems and wisdom of Data Services to M.S. Urban Data Science students whom I am fortunate enough to work with and teach. Suffice it to say, Data Services is a mainstay in my classrooms, and a huge part of my success and professional development at NYU.

Featured Data

NYU | UltraViolet

What's New in Ultraviolet

UltraViolet is part of a suite of repositories at NYU that provide a home for research materials. Data Services helps NYU researchers prepare their materials for deposit in UltraViolet to facilitate open access and long-term preservation.

This month's featured dataset is uMORPH, a large dataset for urban climate modeling created by Dr. Madhavi Jain and a team at the Urban Systems Lab, led by Dr. Timon McPherson. This important new dataset includes building footprint and building height data for hundreds of cities

around the world; it comprises 24 layers at 100m resolution, including 98.4% of all urban areas of over 50,000 people, which in turn represents 94.5% of the global population! It will be key in understanding issues like how air pollution moves through cities, the urban heat island effect, and more, and has a potential for many interesting secondary uses. We also have the related code!

Data in the Library



Just ahead of the 2026 midterm elections, NYU Libraries has added Dave Leip's Atlas of U.S. Presidential Elections to our data collection! This data provides tables, graphs, and maps for past presidential, senatorial, and gubernatorial elections and includes candidates, parties, popular and electoral vote totals, and voter turnout. NYU community members can access the data in UltraViolet using their NYU credentials. **Please note: Democrats are represented in red and Republicans in blue in this data.**

Spotlight: Hands Off Our Census - Be Heard!



Image Credit: handsoffourcens.us

The United States Census Bureau has extended the deadline for public comment in response to a Federal Register notice that proposes sweeping changes to the decennial census to be implemented in 2030. The new deadline to respond is November 2.

The proposed changes, focused on residency rules and demographic data, threaten the quality and accuracy of the decennial census which is used by a wide variety of researchers, businesses, policymakers, and the general public. They would also have serious consequences for the broader U.S. federal statistical system.

Visit handsoffourcens.us for more information and resources, and learn how to submit your comments to the Federal Register.

Data Services Team Spotlight: Chrissy Gonzalez



Photo Credit: Chrissy Gonzalez

Q. What's your name, program, and year?
A. My name is Chrissy Gonzalez. I'm a part-time student, so I've been at NYU for a while, but I'll be finishing a Master's in Computer Science at Tandon in the Spring.

Q. What's your service area at Data Services and how long have you worked here?
A. I'm the Data Services Repository & Project Developer, which means I work on projects that help display and access research data assets at NYU. I started this summer, so I've been here about 5 months.

Q. What do you like most about working at Data Services?
A. I like that I'm contributing to future research breakthroughs in a small way by helping to make data more visible and accessible. Also, my Data Services coworkers are fantastic!

Q. Describe your favorite data-related project that you've worked on.
A. This summer, I worked on researching 3D file formats and then adding a 3D file previewer to the Ultraviolet repository. There are some amazing projects at NYU that produce 3D data, and in the future, you'll be able to take a look at that work directly in your browser.

Q. What's your favorite place to get a meal or a snack near Bobst Library?
A. I love stopping in to Third Rail Coffee on Sullivan Street on my way to work. The coffee is good, and there are a lot of regulars who bring their cute dogs.

Thanks for reading! We hope to see you soon on the 5th floor at Bobst, at Dibner Library, or online.

- Your friends at Data Services

Visit Our Website

Get Help from Data Services

Join Our Ask-Data-Services Community on Discord

NYU Data Services

View in Browser

NYU Libraries
Elmer Holmes Bobst Library
70 Washington Square South, 5th Floor, New York, NY 10012

https://guides.nyu.edu/dataservices

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